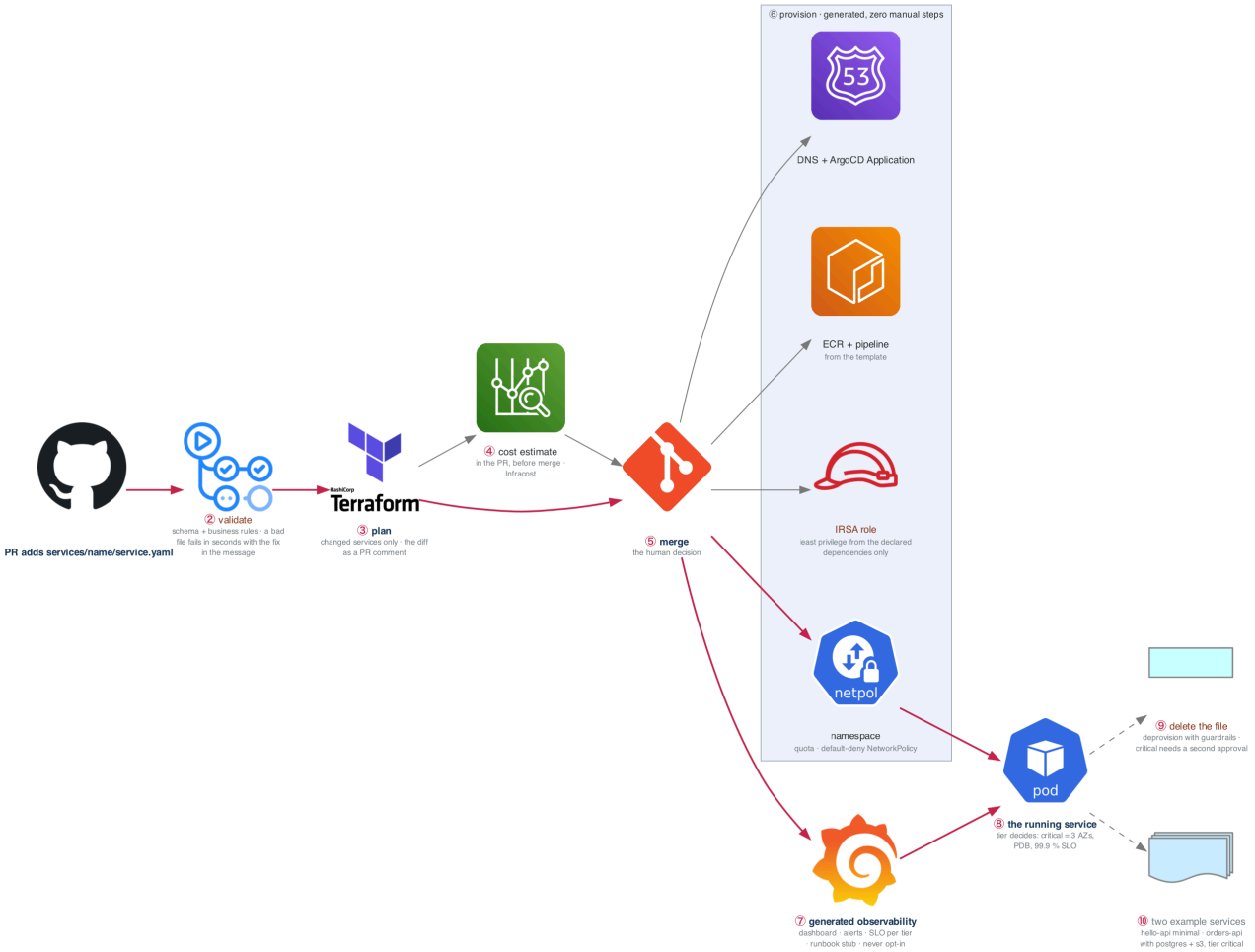
One pull request to a running service, numbered

Week 23 · Figure 23.1 · figure with badges 1–10 · 2026-10-17



What to say, badge by badge

About three and a half minutes at a normal pace (398 words). Point at each badge as you say its line.

Open
“Everything from months 1 to 5 composes here. A developer adds one file and merges; ten minutes later a service is running with a dashboard, an SLO, and a least-privilege role they never wrote. The figure is that ten minutes.”

1 the pull request
“One file in services, named for the service. The developer does not touch Terraform, Kubernetes, or IAM. If they have to, the platform has a gap.”

2 validate
“Schema first, then business rules: the owner must exist in teams.yaml, the tier must be one of three, a critical tier must declare an SLO. The error names the field and the fix. The break/fix for the week is a malformed file, because the error message is the feature.”

3 plan
“Only the services whose files changed are planned. The diff goes on the PR as a comment, which is what the reviewer reads.”

4 cost estimate
“Infracost turns the plan into dollars per month and posts it next to the diff. A tier that costs four times more is a conversation before merge, not a surprise on the bill.”

5 merge
“The one human decision in the flow. Everything after it is a machine following the contract.”

6 provision
“A namespace with resource quotas and a default-deny policy. An IRSA role whose permissions are generated from the declared dependencies, so a service that declares one S3 bucket read-write gets exactly that. An ECR repository and a pipeline from the template. A DNS record and an ArgoCD Application that deploys it.”

7 generated observability
“A dashboard, alerts, an SLO appropriate to the tier, and a runbook stub with the service's name already in it. The developer does not opt in and cannot opt out. Week 20's lesson, delivered by default.”

8 the running service
“The tier decides the shape. Critical means three availability zones, a PodDisruptionBudget, and a 99.9 percent SLO. Experimental means one replica and an auto-expiry so nothing is production without an SLO.”

9 delete the file
“Deleting the file deprovisions everything, through the same pipeline, with guardrails: a critical service needs a second approval and the data store is retained. Deprovisioning that is harder than provisioning is how platforms accumulate ghosts.”

10 two example services
“hello-api with nothing declared, and orders-api with Postgres, an S3 bucket, and tier critical. Both provisioned through the platform. They are the stranger test's starting point next week.”

Close
“Validate, plan with a price, merge, generate everything, run, and remove cleanly. Zero manual steps between merge and a running service is the exit criterion, and Gate 6 times it.”